



>>“Ecommerce is nowhere close to even starting out”>>

>>Bhavin Turakhia, Founder and CEO, Directi

At your keynote you emphasized the point that people should stop buying domains, but focus on building products instead. Is there something wrong with Indian web devs?

Besides the fact that I was trying to make a bold point by means of an extreme statement, yes I think we're at a pivot where, as a country, we need to focus on more and more entrepreneurs who're building products as opposed to people who're only building websites or web apps for other people. And we have the talent, amazing people, as many of our folk are the ones who're sitting in places like Google and Facebook and building all these products. Many of these guys need to take initiative and build something themselves.

India's at a cusp where we're a country of a billion people and we're extremely underserved in terms of technology products (yet) and the internet penetration is just starting to boom. So in the next 6-10 years there's going to be a lot of opportunities for technology consumption here, and either those opportunities are going to be lapped up by companies abroad who serve them or Indian entrepreneurs. And I'd rather that people here would take that step forward.

Do you think Indian developers don't congregate enough to exchange ideas and learn from each other?

I completely agree, although the scene's changing in places like Bangalore and Hyderabad and down south where there

are many more activities, but yeah there are far more forums and opportunities for knowledge sharing in the US as compared to India. And this is something that needs to change.

Do you think Web devs in India are leveraging the telecom sector in our country smartly?

Yeah, that's what I meant by opportunities. I think India's in a unique position where internet penetration is still at 15% and I think it will pump up to 50% in the next four years opening up a tremendous number of opportunities. Think about a scenario where 1 out of 10 people who're connected to the internet versus 1 out of 10 people who accesses the internet. It's a massive difference, opening up a lot of opportunities in the technology space. Even more so now because every single individual in this country of over 1 billion people will be carrying a computer (your smartphone's essentially faster than your computer now), and we'll see the way people lead their lives drastically change in a decade compared to the last three or four decades. So there are a lot of opportunities to tap into, and now's the time

With so many big names joining the ecommerce industry, do you think the space is saturated for Web devs trying to make a name there?

Actually, the ecommerce space is nowhere close to even starting out. The biggest problem with e-commerce right now is

the lack of payment infrastructure in the country. This is a problem unique to very few countries, India being one of them. Everywhere else, because of the prevalence of credit cards and other forms of payment, it is very easy to cover over 70 to 80 percent of the population (even more in the US). Compare that to India, where the total no. of credit cards is just shy of 20 million, which translates to a negligible percentage of our population -- and the number's not going to increase very rapidly. Ecommerce can't work if you can't figure out a payment mechanism. That's one big opportunity right there -- anybody who cracks payments in India is going to have a huge business built out for them.

If this payment problem's going to be solved, a key channel is to engage telcos. But the thing about telcos is that they think of payments as VAS (Value Added Services), where they make margins of 70 to 80 per cent. So on payments they expect a 30 per cent margin, and that just doesn't work out, you can't really work with those margins. The problem with telcos is sort of universal -- nowhere in the world have telcos been great

We met Bhavin at BigRock's HTTPX (<http://bigrockhttpx.net>), an event focused for web developers. Catch the full interview online at <http://dgit.in/imposibru33>. >

Read more about the happenings of the httpx event online, at: www.thinkdigit.com and share your comments.

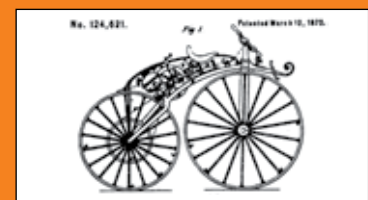
*open source



A backdoor to linux?

>>Linux has always had a reputation for being a secure OS, but so have many others and NSA seems to have had free reign in seemingly every secure system. But what about Linux? Linus Torvalds took centerstage at LinuxCon with some interesting answers.

<http://dgit.in/1aYQtbZ>



Patents vs. open source

>>Patents are everywhere and so broad that sifting through what's acceptable and what's not is too tedious a task. Andrew Casillas, director at linuxdefenders.org, spoke (at LinuxCon) of the work they've been doing to safeguard open-source software and keep patent trolls at bay.

<http://dgit.in/19wYg2S>